VIT BHOPAL

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Branch – CSE(Core)

Year – 2025-26

Course Code – CSE0001

Date - 29/03/2026

Introduction

This project is about building the kind of digital skills that actually matter for students today, whether it's knowing how to use the right tools, communicating professionally, or staying safe online. It walks through several hands-on tasks, each tackling something real and relevant. From designing a digital literacy infographic and setting up a professional portfolio, to practising on a coding platform, writing proper emails, and exploring a cybercrime case study, every task connects to something students genuinely encounter. The goal is to grow technical confidence, build good internet habits, and create a professional presence worth being proud of. Working through all of this gives students real experience with tools they'll keep using, long after the project is done.

Task 1 - Infographic

I made a digital literacy awareness infographic on Canva, starting with a portrait-style layout because it felt cleaner and easier to read through. The infographic covers the basics of digital literacy, including what it actually means, which tools are useful for students, and how to stay safe online. I described digital literacy simply as knowing how to use technology well and responsibly. I also included everyday tools like Google Docs, online learning platforms, and communication apps that genuinely help with productivity. On the safety side, I focused on things like using strong passwords, not clicking on sketchy links, and keeping personal information private. While putting it together, I tried to keep things visual and avoid cramming in too much text, which was harder than it sounds. Playing around with Canva's templates was actually fun, and helped me put together something that looked proper. The trickiest part was deciding what to leave out so the design didn't feel overwhelming.

All in all, this task made me realise how much a well-designed visual can do that a wall of text simply can't, especially when it comes to spreading awareness.

Task 2 - Digital Portfolio

I set up and filled out my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle to start building a proper digital presence. On GitHub, I made a profile README that mentions my name, branch, academic year, and what I'm working towards. It's somewhere I can actually show my coding work and see how far I've come over time. On LinkedIn, I filled in my Education section with my degree details, institution name, and when I expect to graduate. I want to use it to make useful connections, look into internship options, and stay in the loop with what's happening in the industry. On Kaggle, I got my profile ready so I can start looking at datasets, joining competitions, and building up my understanding of data science and machine learning.

Over the next four years, I want to keep adding to these profiles, whether that's new projects, achievements, or certifications. Keeping them updated feels like one of the most practical things I can do right now to open doors for internships and placements later.

Task 3 - Platforms

Coding Practice Platform

For Task 3, I explored coding practice by signing up on HackerRank. I went with HackerRank because it felt beginner-friendly and the challenges are actually designed to make you think, not just memorise syntax. I worked through a Tic Tac Toe problem in Python, where I had to write logic that picks the best possible move by checking winning combinations, stopping the opponent from winning, and finding an open spot when needed. Getting it to work properly helped me see how the concepts I'd read about, like loops, conditionals, and arrays, actually come together in a real problem. The platform is genuinely useful for practising coding, getting ready for technical interviews, and training yourself to think more clearly. The feedback it gives after each attempt also makes it easy to spot where you went wrong and fix it.

I plan to keep solving problems on HackerRank regularly, especially to get more comfortable with data structures and algorithms. Earning a few badges and certifications along the way would also be a nice bonus, since those things genuinely help when applying for internships and jobs.

Google Workspace Collaboration Report

For this task, I used Google Forms to put together a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. I kept it to five questions, mixing multiple-choice and short-answer formats, to check how well people understand digital safety, online communication, and responsible internet use.

Making the form taught me how to phrase questions clearly, pick the right type of input, and lay things out so it doesn't feel confusing. I also figured out how to share the form through a link and track the responses as they came in. It was a simple but eye-opening exercise in how digital tools can make collaboration and awareness-building much easier in a college setting.

Honestly, Google Workspace is one of those tools that makes student life noticeably easier, from running surveys to collecting assignment responses and organising data. I can already see how useful it'll be for group projects and anything that involves gathering feedback or managing information going forward.

Task 4 - Email Etiquette

Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

I wrote two professional emails as part of this task, both focused on getting the tone and structure right. The first was to a professor asking for an assignment extension, and the second was to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship. Both emails followed the basics of professional communication, a clear subject line, a proper greeting, a well-organised message, and a polite sign-off.

Through this task, I really understood why tone matters so much in written communication. Being respectful, getting to the point, and saying things clearly can completely change how someone reads your message. I also put together a quick do's and don'ts checklist for email etiquette that others can use as a reference. Overall, it was one of those tasks that felt very practical and something I know I'll actually use throughout college and beyond.

Digital Communication Reflection

A situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem is when a student messaged a professor with something like "Send me the assignment marks fast." There was no subject line, no greeting, and the tone came across as demanding rather than respectful. The professor understandably found it off-putting, which left a bad impression and meant the student had to wait much longer for a reply.

It could have gone very differently with just a bit more care. A simple subject line, a proper greeting, and a politely worded request, something like asking for an update on assignment results, would have made the whole exchange smoother. How you write to people digitally says a lot about you, and it genuinely affects how people respond, especially in academic and professional settings.

Task 5 - Cybercrime

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

For Task 5, I put together a case study on **phishing**, which is one of the most common ways people get tricked online into giving away passwords or banking details. In the case study, I explained how phishing usually works through fake emails or messages that look like they're from a trusted source, leading the person to a fraudulent website.

I walked through the process step by step, looking at how victims get targeted, with a particular focus on students and people who haven't had much exposure to online security. The case study also looked at what can go wrong as a result, including losing money, having your identity stolen, or having personal data leaked.

Working through this task honestly made me a bit more cautious about how I use the internet. It's easy to assume you won't fall for something like this, but studying real examples changes that. I now have a clearer sense of what to watch out for, like always checking links before clicking, not trusting messages that feel off, and not cutting corners on security.

Reflection (Personal Learning)

While going through UPI and online payment fraud cases, what genuinely caught me off guard was how little it takes for someone to lose a significant amount of money. I used to think cybercrime was mostly about sophisticated hacking, but it turns out most of it comes down to small, everyday mistakes, like confirming a UPI PIN without stopping to understand what the request is actually for. Seeing how scammers play on urgency and trust to catch people off guard was honestly a wake-up call.

The one thing I'm taking away from this is to just pause before doing anything involving a payment or an unfamiliar link. A few extra seconds to verify the source and understand what's being asked can make a real difference. I also want to pass this awareness on to family and friends who might not be as alert to these kinds of threats as they should be.

Conclusion

Looking back, this project covered a lot of ground and each task taught me something I can actually use. I learned how to present ideas visually, put together a professional online presence, and get more comfortable with coding through real practice. Writing proper emails made me think more carefully about how I communicate, and researching cybercrime made me a lot more aware of the risks that come with being online. Taken together, these activities have made me more confident about using digital tools the right way. I feel like the things I picked up here will genuinely stay with me, both through the rest of my degree and when I eventually step into a professional environment

References

Canva – For infographic creation

GitHub – For digital portfolio

LinkedIn – For professional profile

Kaggle – For data science practice

HackerRank – For coding challenges

Google Forms – For quiz and collaboration

General knowledge on phishing and cyber safety (educational resources)